

INSTAGRAM DATA COLLECTION



1 fetch shortcodes

Selenium and Firefox were used in a Python script that fetched Instagram shortcodes. These are unique identifiers per post. A post can be a single image, a set of images (carousel), or a video.
 $N_{accounts} = 15$
 $N_{shortcodes} = 6,174$

2 collect metadata, captions, images, thumbnails

The instaloader library was called in python to collect the relevant data per shortcode. This took time due to hard rate limits.

3 clean & validate

After 2 retries on failed shortcodes, the total number of collected captions is 6,150 (59 missing). A closer inspection revealed that the failed shortcodes redirected to sensitive content.
 $N_{captions} = 6,150$
 $N_{images} = 6,336$ (66,8%)
 $N_{videos} = 3,156$ (33,2%)



NEWS OUTLET DATA COLLECTION



1 fetch article_urls, title, metadata

For De Volkskrant and De Telegraaf, the online archive is used to fetch URLs. For NOS, the API entry is used to fetch article id's and manually construct URLs.

2 collect img_urls, img_alt, lead

With web scraping in Python. As part of this step, sports and entertainment articles are filtered out.

3 crop & download faces from news images

The news images are opened in the browser, onto which InsightFace is applied to detect, crop, resize and download faces.
 $N_{faces} = 114,261$

4 classify politicians in cropped faces from news images

All news faces are embedded with FaceNet512. They are then compared to the embeddings of a custom training set with the relevant politicians.

5 correct & validate classifications

Drag-and-drop is used to relabel misclassifications. NLP is used to restore labels for articles with a politician or party mentioned in the title, but unlabelled yet.
 $N_{labelled_politicians} = 3,923$

the populist gaze

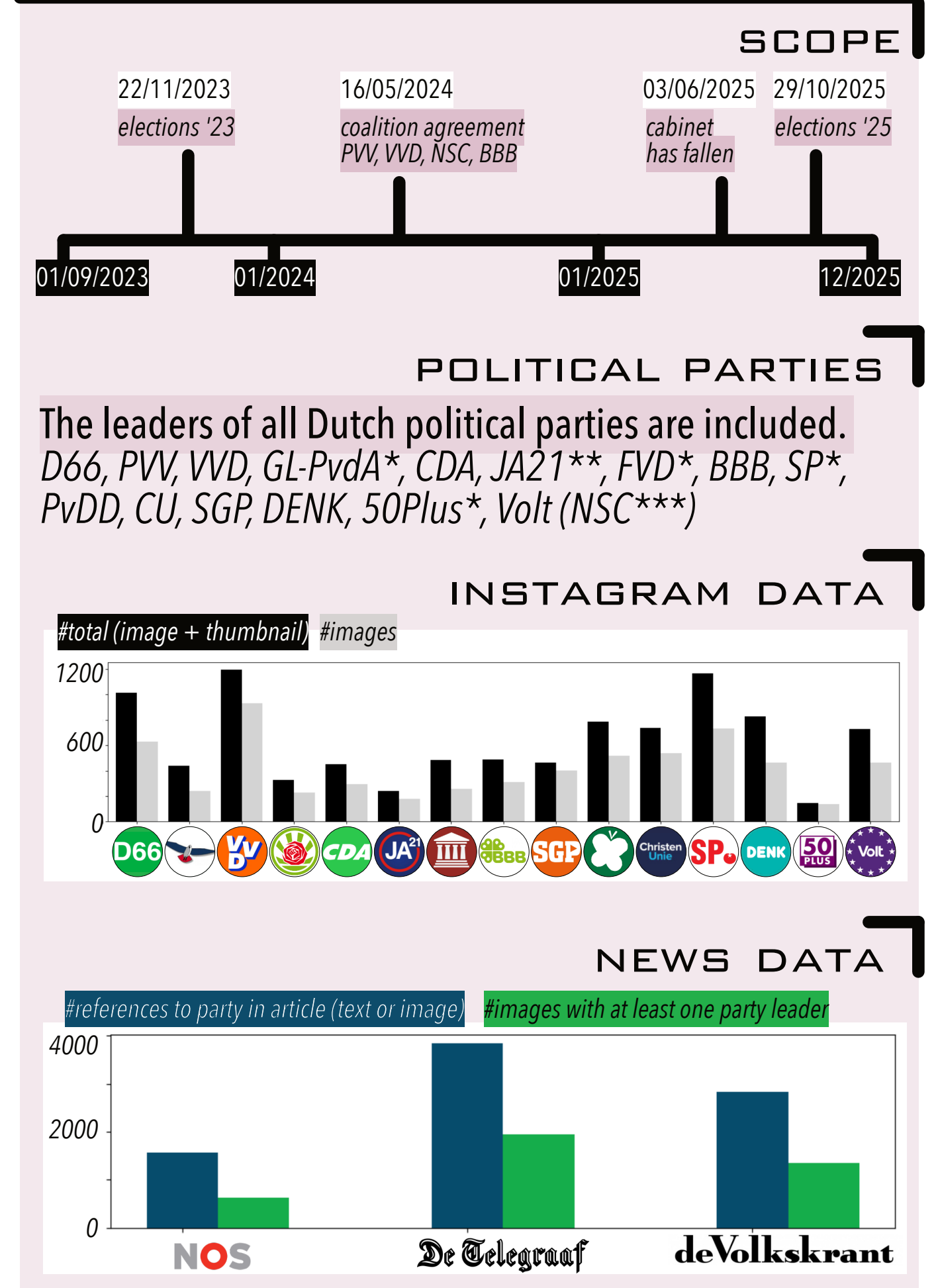
SCIENTIFIC & SOCIETAL RELEVANCE

News outlets play a crucial role in democracy, as they are to hold power to account. Meanwhile, politicians rely on social media to communicate with voters directly. Studies to populism as a communication style have shown how populist language is textually manifested in their social media communication. However, less is known about the interplay of their rhetoric and visual language. Given the complicated relation of populist actors and the press, this project aims to arrive at a comparison of multimodal framing by populists (Instagram) and about populists (press).

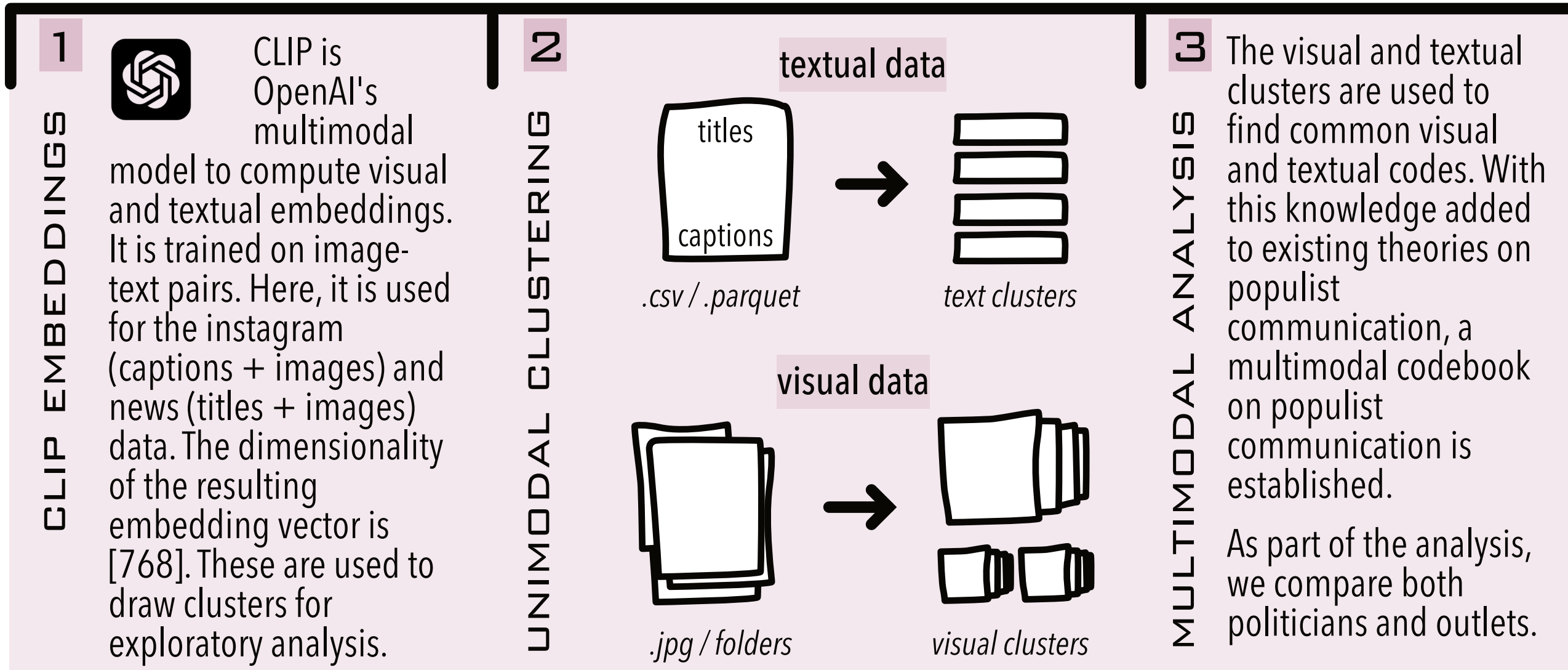
RESEARCH QUESTIONS

1. Can populist communication be coded in multimodal manner?
2. To what extent do news reportst (by journalists) converge / diverge with social media posts (by politicians) in multimodal manner?
3. Does the degree of convergence / divergence differ between populists and pluralists?

DATA DESCRIPTIVES



METHODOLOGY



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